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Head of Platform Engineering (Senior Technical Architect)

Government Property Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Tuesday 1st September 2026



Government
Property
Agency

Reference number

474971

Salary

£56,500 - £62,554

There is a higher starting salary available of : £62,000 per annum.

A Recruitment and Retention Allowance (RRA) is available for up to £10,000 for candidates that meet the right skills and experience. This will

be reviewed annually and is not consolidated for pension. The total salary package is negotiable for exceptional candidates.

GPA is also committed to recognising and rewarding where our staff hold the Gold Standard accreditation relevant to their Specialism and offer a £5000 non-pensionable allowance to staff who have achieved this.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7
GPA G7 National

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GPA - Chief Operating Office - IT Delivery

Type of role

Architecture and Data

Working pattern

Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Birmingham, Bristol, Cardiff, Leeds, Manchester, Nottingham, Swindon

About the job

Job summary

The Government Property Agency is the largest property holder in government, with more than £2.1 billion in property assets and over 55% of the government's office estate.

We are transforming the way the Civil Service works by creating great places to work, leading the largest commercial office programme in the UK, working towards halving carbon emissions from government offices, and achieving greater value for taxpayers. And we are looking for innovative, solutions-focused people to join our team.

Representing the best covenant in the UK – His Majesty's Government – we are leading transformational programmes such as the Government Hubs Programme, Whitehall Campus Programme and Net Zero Programme, as well as delivering modern, cost-effective real estate service solutions.

Innovation and progress are at the heart of our behaviours. We foster a culture of lifelong learning, where curiosity and self-improvement are encouraged. And we're dedicated to becoming a leading, inclusive employer both in the external market and throughout the Civil Service. Our strong emphasis on Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion (EDI) is not just about driving inclusion across our organisation, it is also about ensuring our services meet the needs of government departments and the civil servants who use our spaces.

Join our dynamic and diverse team that leads with purpose, improving sustainability, nurturing social value, driving inclusivity and flexibility, and kickstarting economic growth. We are driven by purpose, and you can be part of it too: where you make a meaningful impact; where you influence; where your voice really matters; where you help to shape our future direction.

Job description

The role will be responsible for overseeing the contract administration of a number of Workplace Services contracts, ensuring compliance, efficiency, and alignment with organisational objectives.

These contracts include (but are not limited to) Hard FM, Soft FM, Catering, Operational Security and Performance Partner across the national portfolio. The numbers and types of contracts will flex with business needs.

The role requires a proactive approach to, optimising the efficiency and effectiveness of contract administration, working closely with the Operational Contract managers to improve performance, and mitigating risks associated with contractual and service delivery obligations.

Person specification

You will have:

Deep experience in Contract Management gained on large complex multi-site service contracts ideally in the public sector across national and/or regional landscapes.

The credibility, diplomacy and gravitas to represent the GPA's interests when dealing with very senior management from suppliers.

A strong communicator, able to work with a range of audiences and provide strategic and operational performance information that is clear and concise to support the GPAs decision making.

Able to think creatively and innovatively about problems and explore solutions based on evidence and data to support the goals of the GPA.

Collaborative in your approach, encouraging challenge and discussion from stakeholders to drive effective negotiation and pragmatic solutions.

Able to handle a high workload and a wide variety of tasks and take care in prioritising work and managing stakeholder expectations.

A good written communicator, able to explain complex procedures and policies in clear language for a range of audiences applying consideration to accessibility and diversity.

Experience & Technical Skills

Essential criteria:

Management of large, complex, multi-site service contracts across national and/or regional landscapes

Accredited Expert in Contract Management (Government Commercial College) or prepared to follow a learning path to achieve.

Excellent strategic and people leadership skills

Good communication skills

Organisational skills

Desirable criteria:

Member of CIPS

CIWFM or FIWFM

CCM Advanced Practitioner / CCM Expert

Experience of delivery under NEC3 and NEC4 contracts.

Data analysis skills

Public Sector experience

Governance & controls experience

Commercial sector experience

Qualifications and Accreditations

Gold Standard Accreditations - to hold or be able to demonstrate working towards - CIWFM/FIWFM

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Seeing the Big Picture

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Leadership

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Customer Perspective

Commercial Acumen

Property Market Knowledge

Innovation

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £56,500, Government Property Agency contributes £16,368 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A [Civil Service pension](#) with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

We encourage applications from people from all backgrounds and aim to have a workforce that represents the communities and wider society that we serve. We pride ourselves on being an employer of choice. We champion diversity, inclusion and well-being and aim to create a sense of belonging in a workplace where everyone feels valued. The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Please note - At this time GPA are unable to offer any Visa Sponsorship to candidates as we do not currently hold a visa sponsorship licence. Please do not apply for permanent roles with GPA if you will require your employer to take on the sponsorship of your current or any future visas.

Sift

As part of the application process, you will be asked to include a CV and a 750-word personal statement. The personal statement should align with the person specification.

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

The sift is due to take place week commencing **2nd and 3rd September 2026**.

Interview

GPA policy is for interviews to be held face to face, with virtual interviews only by absolute exception. The date and location will be confirmed if you are invited to interview. If you feel this will be a problem for you, please contact recruitment@gpa.gov.uk to discuss prior to submitting your application.

Interviews will involve an Initial short screening call and then if successful followed by a final in-person interview.

At interview, applicants will be scored against **4** behaviours - Seeing the Big Picture, Making Effective Decisions, Communicating and Influencing and Leadership.

Interview questions will be a blend of Behaviour, Experience, Strength and Technical (core skill).

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact ddatsupport@gpa.gov.uk soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

Current Civil Servants (all contract types) will need to ensure that they are still employed as a civil servant at the point of starting in the relevant new post. If their contract ends (e.g., end of FTA contract or resignation) at any point during the recruitment/onboarding process for the advertised role, they will no longer be eligible and may be withdrawn.

Please note: in addition to the standard pre-employment checks for appointment into the Civil Service, all candidates must also obtain National Security Vetting at Security Check level for this vacancy. You will normally need to meet the minimum UK residency period as determined by the level of vetting being undertaken, which for CTC is 3 years UK residency prior to your vetting application. If you have any questions about this residency requirement, please speak to the vacancy holder for this post.

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

A reserve list may be held for a period of 12 months from which further appointments can be made.

Any move to GPA from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare; for further information [visit the Childcare Choices website](#).

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service on your behalf.

However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be

available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

To apply please click the link below.

[Apply now](#)

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Matt Cupit

Email : matthew.cupit1@gpa.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : ddatsupport@gpa.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact HR@gpa.gov.uk

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission:

Click [here](#) to visit Civil Service Commission

